An Roinn Oideachais
Department of Education

Digital Strategy for Schools
Implementation Plan 2024

November 2024

Contents

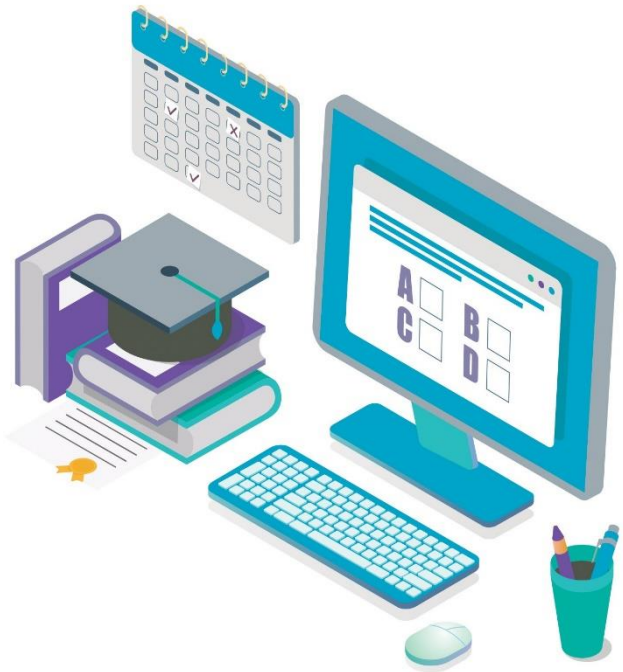
Introduction	**3**
Pillar 1 Actions	**7**
Pillar 2 Actions	**13**
Pillar 3 Actions	**16**
Measurement and Oversight Actions	**22**

Introduction

Under the Digital Strategy for Schools to 2027, there is a commitment to publish an Implementation Plan to support the overarching objectives of the strategy. This Implementation Plan provides an overview of the many actions underway since the publication of the strategy, as well as new actions to be undertaken with associated timelines.

As well as outlining the actions and timelines, the plan also sets out the many supports and resources that are currently available to school leaders and teachers in embedding digital technology across teaching, learning and assessment.

The vision of the Digital Strategy for Schools to 2027 is to empower schools to harness the opportunities of digital transformation and build digital competence in both teachers and learners. This plan demonstrates the Department's commitment to support and advance this vision, with funding, supports and resources for teacher professional learning and school leaders.



A key factor in the implementation of the strategy is that all learners are provided with the opportunity to use digital technologies during their learning. This opportunity will help learners reach their full potential and provide them with the digital skills needed for an increasingly technology enabled world.

This Implementation Plan sets out actions under each of the three pillars as set out in the strategy:

Pillar 1 - Supporting the embedding of digital technologies in teaching, learning and assessment.

This pillar focuses on the embedding of digital technologies across all aspects of teaching, learning and assessment. It centres on approaches to support teachers and school leaders to ensure that they have the necessary skills and confidence to equip learners with the knowledge and skills required for the modern world.

Pillar 2 – Digital Technology Infrastructure.

This pillar focuses on technology in the context of infrastructure development in schools including broadband connectivity and technical support and procurement frameworks.

Pillar 3 - Looking to the future: policy, research and digital leadership.

This pillar deals with alignment of the strategy with relevant EU and government policies and also looks at the important aspect of online safety, new and emerging technologies and the associated issues for the education sector.

Timeline

This plan will run to mid 2025, with a review of the strategy to be undertaken early next year and a new Implementation Plan to be published early in the second half of 2025.

Key Developments under the Digital Strategy for Schools to date

FUNDING

- €100m issued in ICT infrastructure grants to all schools
- €50m issued under the NRRP to all schools to support them in addressing the digital divide

CONNECTIVITY

- €15m invested annually by the Department for broadband connectivity to schools
- All primary, post primary and special schools have high speed connectivity

SCHOOL SUPPORT & TEACHER PROFESSIONAL LEARNING

- Oide TiE website expanded and redeveloped
- Extensive range of professional learning available on the effective use of digital technologies in education
- 875 school visits by Oide technology in education advisers and 48,500 digital technology in education TPL interactions
- Development of AI Hub on Oide TiE website
- Over 24,000 high quality digital resources available at scoilnet.ie
- Digital Communities of Practice established between DEIS schools
- Digital Strategy Workshop for school leaders developed and rolled out

WEBWISE

- 3 million views of webwise.ie and 337,000+ resource downloads
- National campaigns on online safety for parents and teachers

WELLBEING

- Initiation of 'Digital Citizenship Champions' programme
- Keeping Childhood Smartphone Free guidelines issued along with webinars and parents information sessions.

RESEARCH

- Publication of final ERC report of the Longitudinal Digital Learning Framework Evaluation
- OECD research underway on the impact of digital devices on student learning, due to be completed by end 2024

Pillar 1

Supporting the embedding of digital technologies in teaching, learning and assessment

OBJECTIVES

Empower learners to become confident and competent digital learners.

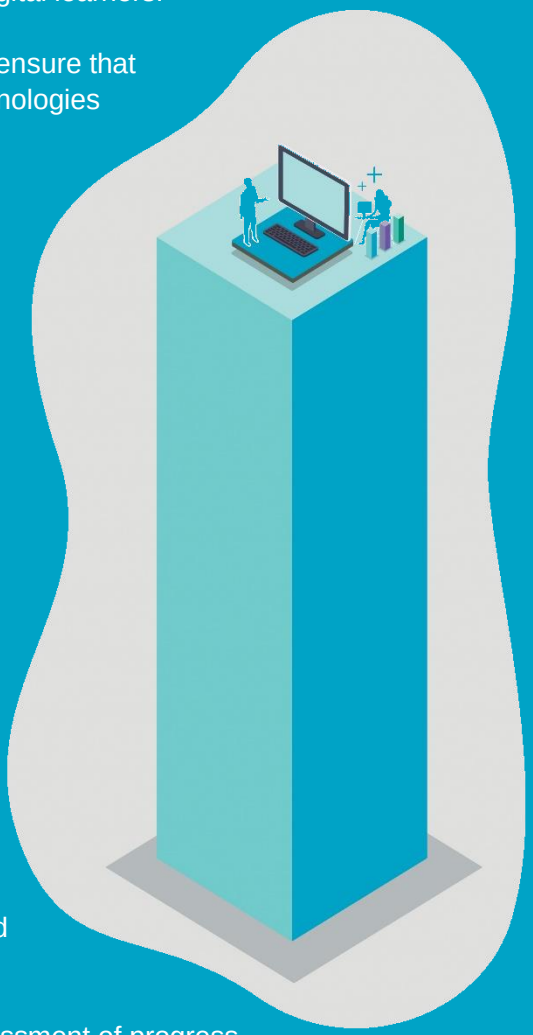
All new educational policies and curricula will continue to ensure that they have the appropriate and effective use of digital technologies embedded.

Enhance inclusion, equity, learner participation and personalisation through the use of digital technologies by providing clear guidance and support.

Embed the appropriate and effective use of digital technologies for teaching, learning and assessment at each stage of the continuum of teacher education, i.e. Initial Teacher Education, Induction and Continuing Professional Development.

Run an awareness programme to ensure that all teachers and school leaders are aware of supports and resources available relating to the use of digital technologies for teaching, learning and assessment both nationally and internationally.

Ensure provision of flexible, differentiated, needs based teacher professional learning so that there is clear guidance, support and professional learning for all teachers and school leaders in the planning and use of digital technologies in all aspects of teaching, learning and assessment.



Provide further supports to assist schools in their selfassessment of progress in embedding digital technologies in teaching, learning and assessment.

Pillar 1 Actions

Action No.	Pillar 1 Actions	Lead/Delivered By	Timeline
1.1	Ensure active student particpation and engagement in relation to digital learning and technology in schools including possibility of holding a National Youth Assembly on this topic.	DE/DCEDIY	Long term
1.2	Organise a one day annual Festival of Digital Learning to showcase best practice on the use of digital technologies in schools for all schools and ITE providers.	DE/OIDE TiE	Long term
1.3	The Dept of Education, through OIDE, will promote TPL supports and resources on the embedding of digital technologies through all curricular areas.	DE/OIDE	In progress
1.4	Develop and expand the Oide TiE website, incorporating new themed pages/hubs on topics including AI, blended learning and other digital learning themes, leadership case studies and digital skills content.	OIDE TiE	Completed
1.5	Targeted promotion of new and existing content on the Oide TiE website, via social media and other channels.	OIDE TiE	In progress
1.6	Produce long form content and articles for dissemination to teachers and school leaders on topics including digital inclusion, emerging technologies, digital leadership and effective digital learning planning.	OIDE TiE	In progress
1.7	Continue to develop, produce and promote videos and case studies of good practice and short online learning resources to be made available on the Oide TiE website.	OIDE TiE	In progress
1.8	Develop additional digital skills tutorials and make them available via the Oide TiE website.	OIDE TiE	In progress
1.9	Increased promotion of Scoilnet as the Department of Education's portal for teachers and schools with its database of 24,000+ resources tagged to the Irish curriculum, including the promotion of digital content initiatives that support learners in specific subjects.	Scoilnet/DE	In progress

1.10	Support schools and school leaders in digital learning planning through: 1. Promoting the www.dlplanning.ie website and the interactive Digital Learning Framework as a planning resource. 2. Mapping good practice to standards and statements in the DLF. 3. Developing an online course for digital learning leaders.	OIDE TiE	In progress
1.11	Review the Digital Learning Framework in the context of its evaluation and updated digital competency frameworks at European level e.g., SELFIE, DigComp 2.2, to ensure it remains relevant and appropriate.	DE	Medium Term
1.12	Map all newly developed and existing online professional learning for teachers and digital leaders to the competencies of the DigCompEdu Framework.	OIDE TiE/DE	In progress
1.13	Upgrade online courses platform software to enhance user experience.	OIDE TiE/DE	Completed
1.14	Continue the provision of bespoke onsite support for schools in embedding digital technologies in teaching, learning and assessment.	OIDE TiE	In progress
1.15	Deliver summer courses through the Education Support Centre Network on a range of topics to support the embedding of digital technologies in teaching, learning and assessment.	OIDE TiE	In progress
1.16	Establish and support Digital Communities of Practice with primary and post primary school leaders from DEIS Schools.	OIDE TiE	Completed
1.17	Develop and roll out a Digital Strategy Workshop for school leaders focusing on the key areas regarding digital learning and planning and supports available.	OIDE TiE	Completed
1.18	Implement Digital Learning modules in the Leadership Misneach (newly appointed principals) and Tánaiste (newly appointed deputy principals) programmes at both Primary and Post-Primary level. These modules focus on the digital learning planning process.	OIDE TiE	Completed
1.19	Design new 'Leading Digital Learning' online course, videos and supports targeted at digital learning coordinators and school	OIDE TiE	Completed

	leaders on the development of digital learning in schools.		
1.20	Create a new Digital Learning for Modern Foreign Languages online course, in partnership with the Post Primary Languages Initiative (PPLI), incorporating the DLF and supporting the aims of the Languages Connect Strategy.	PPLI/OIDE TiE	Completed
1.21	Update and provide key online courses for teachers and school leaders on important topics such as Digital Citizenship and using digital technology to support Education for Sustainable Development.	OIDE TiE	Completed
1.22	In line with the new Primary Curriculum Framework support coding and computational thinking including through: 1. various workshops and projects such as a nationwide Plugged Coding Workshop, 2. promotion of EU Code week activities, 3. implementation of computational thinking and creativity across the continuum projects and 4. support of the WEAVE project (culturally responsive computational thinking)	OIDE TiE/DE	Short term
1.23	Sustain the annual intake of schools to the primary and post-primary 'Formative Assessment Using Digital Portfolios' initiative. This initiative explores how the use of digital portfolios can support and enhance formative assessment practices.	OIDE TiE	Medium term
1.24	Implement practitioner training programme on blended learning (REBEL) and develop webinar and case studies to illustrate inclusive blended learning practice.	OIDE TiE	Completed
1.25	Working with the School of Inclusive Education, DCU, implement a digital learning module in the Graduate Diploma in Inclusive Educatuion.	OIDE TiE	Completed
1.26	Engage with NCSE to ensure that students with additional needs can benefit from digital technologies to support an inclusive education system.	DE/NCSE	In progress
1.27	Oide TiE to engage with the NCSE to advise on provision of relevant supports and guidance for the use of technology to support inclusive practice.	OIDE TiE/NCSE	In progress

1.28	Provide input on digital technology in education at annual forum between the Department of Education, Teaching Council and HEIs on curriculum and policy developments.	DE	Completed
1.29	Support the ITE Sector in the development of digital competencies in the teaching profession. This includes by: - facilitating modules providing an overview of the digital technology supports available to student teachers. - enabling access to TPL online courses. - engaging in partnerships with third level providers to reach wider audiences.	OIDE TiE/HEIs	In progress
1.30	Ensure a consistent, informed and effective approach in the use of digital technologies is embedded and modelled by all divisions in the amalgamated Oide support service, including: modelling good practices in the use of digital technologies, modelling effective practices to counter disinformation and exemplifying opportunities for problem-solving approaches.	OIDE TiE/DE	In progress
1.31	Align with and support the implementation of the Primary Curriculum Framework maintaining a focus on digital skills and digital literacy. This Framework outlines 'being a digital learner' as one of seven key competencies to be embedded in learning outcomes across all curriculum areas and subjects from junior infants to sixth class.	DE/NCCA	In progress
1.32	Support the Primary Language Curriculum/Curaclam Teanga na Bunscoile by promoting the capacity of children to engage with digital technology in creative and imaginative ways and to source, critique and manage information as engaged thinkers and active learners	OIDE TiE/DE	In progress
1.33	Ensure learning related to digital technology, coding and computational thinking will be included in the specification for Science, Technology, and Engineering under the Primary Curriculum Framework.	DE/NCCA	Short term
1.34	Explore the incorporation of media arts within the curriculum area of Arts Education in a redeveloped Primary School Curriculum.	DE	Medium term

1.35	Review and consider recommendations from the early insights review of the junior cycle short course specifications for Digital Media Literacy and Coding.	DE	Medium term
1.36	Explore opportunities to incorporate use of digital technologies as appropriate in curriculum and assessment arrangements for new and revised Leaving Certificate Established subjects and across other Senior Cycle programmes under Senior Cycle redevelopment.	DE/NCCA/SEC	Medium term
1.37	Explore potential to further incorporate digital skills, including coding, within Creative Youth programmes in the context of a broad definition of creativity.	DE	Medium term
1.38	Continue to support schools through the DEIS programme to promote greater achievement in literacy and numeracy, including digital literacy, for children at risk of educational disadvantage and close the achievement gap between DEIS and non-DEIS schools.	DE	In progress
1.39	Continued promotion by the Home School Community Liaison scheme of digital literacy development for parents of children at risk of educational disadvantage through guiding parents to relevant resources and learning opportunities.	DE/TESS	In progress

Pillar 2
Digital Technology Infrastructure

OBJECTIVES

Establish sustainable funding mechanisms for the purchase and maintenance of digital technology infrastructure in schools.

Meet the requirements for all primary, special schools and postprimary schools to embed digital technologies in their teaching, learning and assessment by the provision of appropriate broadband connectivity.

Provide guidance and advice on the purposeful and effective use of digital technology infrastructure to support the embedding of digital technologies in teaching, learning and assessment.

Research, establish and make available technical support solutions that are appropriate to and accessible for all schools

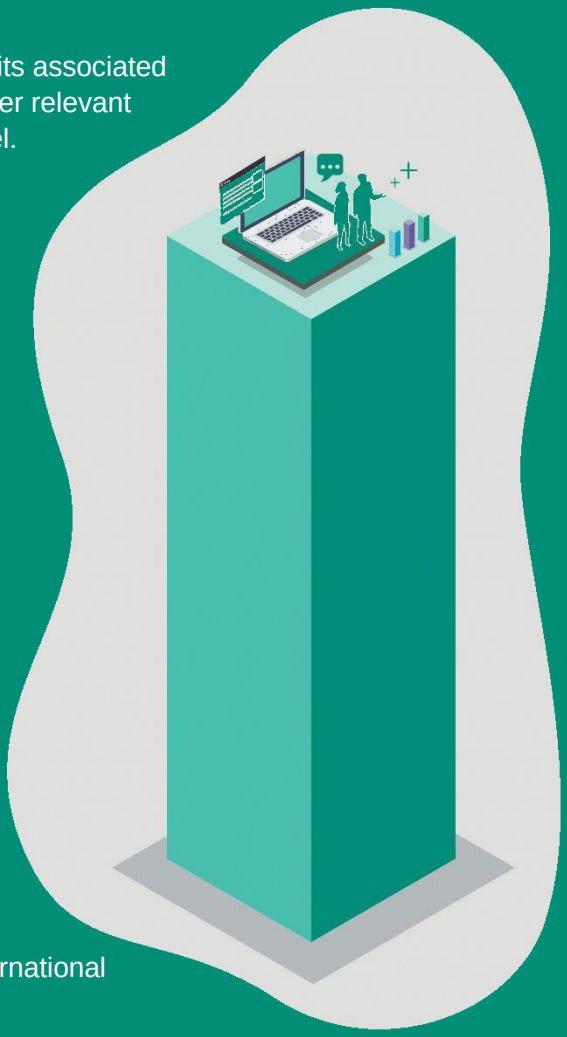
Provide procurement mechanisms for schools, by working with relevant stakeholders, with comprehensive and easy to navigate guidance and support on procurement including how to access those mechanisms, which will assist schools in the purchase of equipment and services aligned to digital learning planning.

Pillar 2 Actions

Action No.	Pillar 2 Actions	Lead/Delivered By	Timeline
2.1	Engage with relevant stakeholders to inform development of mechanism for future funding of digital technology infrastructure incorporating appropriate provision for technical support, in line with technical support solutions identified as part of this plan and address equipment obsolescence as appropriate.	DE	Medium term
2.2	Through the Schools Broadband Programme, continue: - connectivity upgrade to 100 Mbps or greater for primary schools located in the National Broadband Plan Intervention Area (NBP IA), and - connectivity upgrade of primary schools through the NRRP funded project, that is, schools outside of the NBP IA and where industry will not provide high speed connectivity.	DE	Short term
2.3	Consider the functions and processes of the Schools Broadband Services Desk in the context of providing the optimal service to schools in the delivery of the broadband programme.	DE	Medium term
2.4	Provide necessary support and guidance to schools on digital technology infrastructure to highlight relevant topics including: a) appropriate hardware and software for embedding digital technologies in teaching, learning and assessment, with a particular focus on the learner experience, for example in good practice videos, b) infrastructure to support digital learning planning, c) information and links to procurement mechanisms for digital technology for schools where available.	OIDE TiE	In progress
2.5	Ensure the Technology in Education website incorporates content and resources relating to digital technology infrastructure, emerging priorities and identified needs in the sector as required.	OIDE TiE	In progress
2.6	Conduct market research on available technical support solutions, including engagement with industry as required.	DE	Short term

2.7	Based on findings of market research, undertake consultation with education stakeholders to determine appropriate solutions for a sustainable technical support model for all schools.	DE	Short term
2.8	Commence implementation of technical support solutions.	DE, OIDE TiE	Medium term
2.9	Identify, co-ordinate and prioritise key requirements for schools ICT infrastructure procurement mechanisms in collaboration with the OGP, EPS. Schools Procurement Unit, OIDE-TiE and ETBI as appropriate	DE,OIDE TiE, SPU,OGP, EPS	In progress
2.10	Establish Procurement Frameworks for Schools, to be used by the wider Education Sector as appropriate for key infrastructure to support schools.	DE,OIDE TiE, SPU,OGP, EPS	In progress
2.11	Review advice and guidance provided to schools to support them to access all relevant Procurement Frameworks.	DE,OIDE TiE, SPU,OGP	Completed
2.12	Provide advice for schools on cybersecurity, including engaging with the National Cyber Security Centre.	DE, OIDE TiE	Long term
2.13	Work with stakeholders to ensure Data Protection and GDPR guidelines for schools websites remain appropriate for schools	DE, OIDE TiE	In progress
2.14	Provide advice for schools on how align with the Education for Sustainable Development Goals in relation to infrastructure, according to their specific context.	OIDE TiE	In progress
2.15	Work to establish a mechanism for schools to procure WiFi and Associated Services for Schools, including appropriate advice and guidance.	DoE, OIDE TiE, SPU,OGP	Medium term

Pillar 3
Looking to the future: policy, research and digital leadership



OBJECTIVES

Ensure the Digital Strategy for Schools to 2027 and its associated Implementation Plan supports and complements other relevant strategies and polices both nationally and at EU level.

Provide assistance and guidance to schools to understand how relevant strategies related to the use of digital technologies in teaching, learning and assessment can be implemented.

Continue to engage with and monitor relevant international and EU initiatives including the EU DEAP so that research and supports can be considered and adopted for the Irish context and disseminated to the system.

Promote participation and engagement in EU and national research.

Undertake research in key areas to inform the development of relevant supports and resources for schools.

Continue to support the development and dissemination of high quality resources to promote the safe, responsible and ethical use of the internet and digital technology, informed by national and international policy and best practice.

Promote the use of digital technologies to facilitate communication within the wider school community and education ecosystem particularly involving parents and learners.

Pillar 3 Actions

Action No.	Pillar 3 Actions	Lead/Delivered By	Timeline
3.1	Continue to support, promote, disseminate and engage with relevant national and EU strategies that impact the use of digital technologies in education. These include - EU Digital Education Action Plan 2021-2027 - Harnessing Digital: The Digital Ireland Framework - National Strategy on Artificial Intelligence 'AI Here for Good' - Education for Sustainable Development to 2030 - EU Ethical Guidelines on the use of Artificial Intelligence in Education - Guidelines for teachers and educators on tackling disinformation and promoting digital literacy through education and training.	DE	In progress
3.2	Support and align with the implementation of the STEM Education Implementation Plan to 2026, in particular measures to address the gender gap in the uptake of STEM subjects.	DE	In progress
3.3	Support the implementation of the Literacy, Numeracy and Digital Literacy Strategy 2024-2033: Every Learner from Birth to Young Adulthood with a focus on Digital Literacy.	DE	In progress
3.4	Support the implementation of Cinéaltas: Action Plan on Bullying through actions related to Webwise, cyberbullying, engagement with Coimisiún na Meán and representation on the National Advisory Council for Online Safety .	DE	In progress
3.5	Continued promotion and provision of curriculum aligned educational resources and programmes for schools in online safety and digital citizenship to help promote healthy online relationships, digital media literacy and respectful	Webwise	In progress

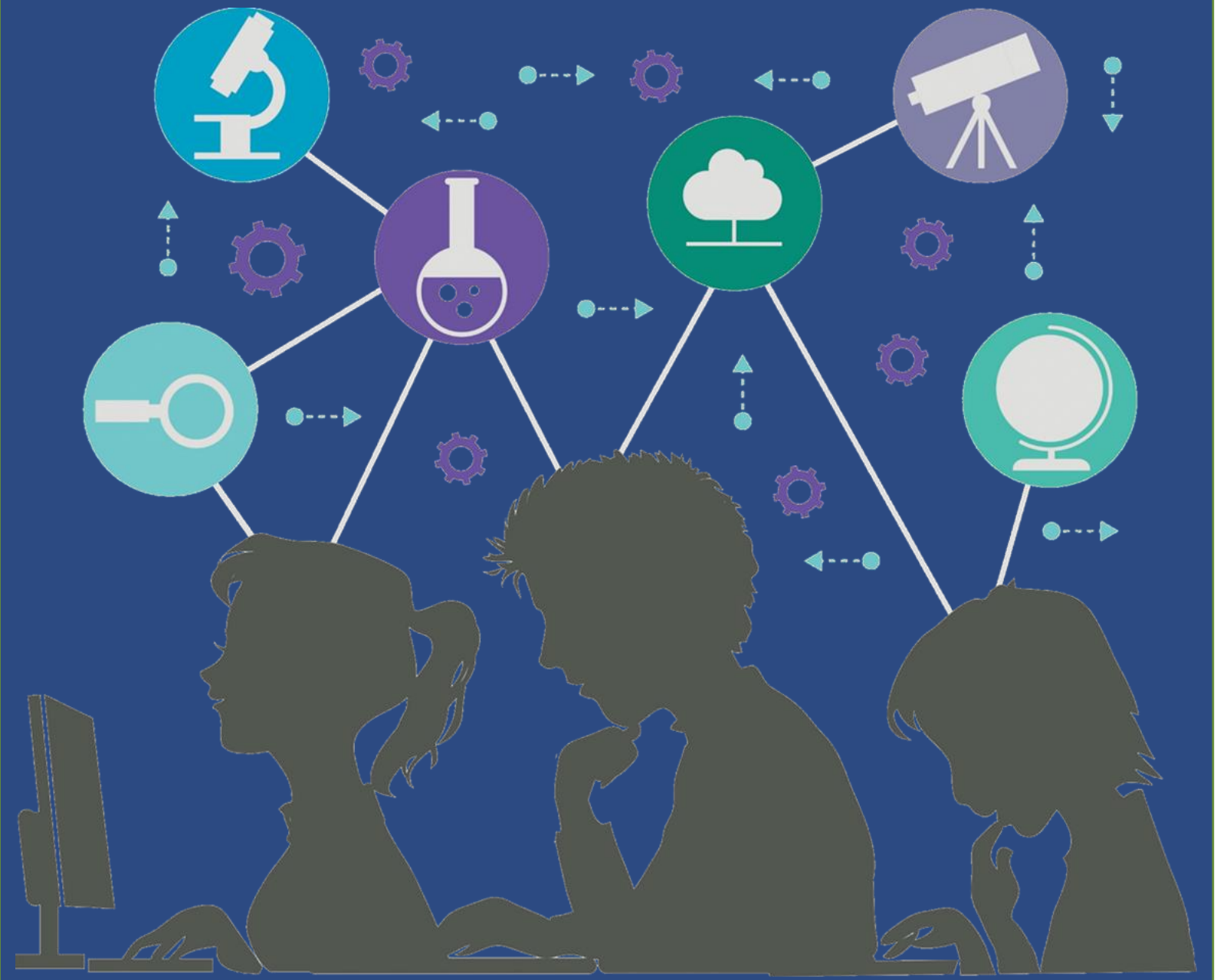
	online communication among young people.		
3.6	Develop New Junior Cycle Unit of Learning for SPHE - Connecting and Communicating Online, exploring how young people connect, communicate and navigate friendships online.	Webwise	Completed
3.7	Promote the use of the Webwise.ie website as the key access point to resources and information for teachers, schools, parents and learners.	Webwise	In progress
3.8	Raise awareness of online safety within schools via initiatives such as Safer Internet Day and engaging with all relevant stakeholders.	Webwise	In progress
3.9	Provide up to date training and CPD for teachers specifically on online safety and the safe and ethical use of the internet through Webwise and the wider Oide Digital Technology Division	Webwise	In progress
3.10	Promote new Online Course for Teachers in the area of cyberbullying	Webwise	Completed
3.11	Engage in targeted awareness raising around the complex issue of online bullying and abuse, reflecting common experiences of young people.	Webwise	Completed
3.12	Develop a guide for parents and parents' associations who wish to engage with their school community regarding internet safety and access to smartphones for primary school children	DE	In progress
3.13	Facilitate a series of face-to-face events and webinars to support parents and teachers in keeping children safe online and informing them of the Keeping Childhood Smartphone Free Initiative	DE and Webwise	Completed
3.14	Develop a primary schools supports booklet - Helping Schools and Families Keep Children Safe Online	Webwise	Completed
3.15	Implement a Digital Citizenship Champions programme for teachers through the Education Support Centre regional network to build capacity to provide support at a local level.	Oide TiE	In progress
3.16	Continue to facilitate youth participtation and student voice through the Webwise	Webwise	In progress

	Youth Advisory Panel (WebYAP), which focuses on the use of online technologies and trains young people to be peer educators.		
3.17	Continue targeted online safety and digital citizenship education awareness raising via engagement with education stakeholders and networks.	Webwise	In progress
3.18	Foster multi-stakeholder cooperation, information sharing of knowledge and expertise with national and international stakeholders.	Webwise	In progress
3.19	Actively participate, contribute to and disseminate findings from: - INSAFE/EC events - Working Group on countering disinformation - Media Literacy Ireland Network	Webwise	In progress
3.20	Implement an AR/VR in the Primary Classroom project to explore ways in which the introduction of augmented and virtual reality into the classroom environment can meaningfully support and enhance teaching, learning and assessment.	OIDE TiE	Completed
3.21	Support schools, teachers and learners in the effective and ethical use of AI. Measures will include : - Implement teacher professional learning in Education for AI and with AI, as part of the learning from the AI4T project - disemminate EU Ethical Guidelines on the Use of AI and Data in Teaching and Learning for Educators - continued engagement with national, EU and international research and bodies to ensure up to date knowledge on AI and develop resources as appropriate	DE/OIDE TiE	Short term
3.22	Develop guidance on the use of AI for teachers and school leaders.	DE/Oide TiE	Medium term
3.23	Develop and promote the AI Hub on Oide TiE website to provide information and resources on AI to teachers and school leaders		Completed

3.24	Establish internal working group to consider implications and possibilites of AI for learners and teachers with engagement with relevant experts and stakeholders as required and examination of extant research.	DE	Short term
3.25	Continued membership of and contribution to the EU Digital Education in Teaching Learning and Assessment Working Group (DELTA) and EU Digital Citzenship and EU Digital Education Hub to ensure awareness and knowledge of what is happening at EU level and in other Member States.	DE	In progress
3.26	Engage with the Educational Repositories Network (EdReNe) - a network of European education ministries and their representatives. Disseminate resources developed in European repositories that are part of the EdReNe network.	Scoilnet/ DE	In progress
3.27	Continued membership and engagement with European Schoolnet and its various initiatives including the Interactive Classroom Working Group, exploring, researching and sharing the effective uses of digital technologies in schools across Europe	DE/Oide TiE	In progress
3.28	eTwinning Ireland to partner with other stakeholders, e.g., OIDE, Regional Education Centres, in an awareness programme to promote eTwinning as a support and resource available relating to the use of digital technologies for teaching, learning and assessment both nationally and internationally.	OIDE / Leargas/ DE	In progress
3.29	Continue to implement the FÍS Film Project initiative, which encourages children to explore the medium of film in the primary classroom developing essential skills in moving-image literacy, communication, teamwork, visual arts and numeracy.	OIDE TiE/ DE	In progress
3.30	Support the National Disinformation Strategy when published, by promotion of existing supports and resources available in Oide and Webwise in	DE/OIDE TiE	Long term

	tackling disinformation and the development of further educational resources.		
3.31	Continued membership of, and contribution to, the Cyber Industry Strategy Strategic Advisory Group.	DE	In progress
3.32	Develop Digital Literacy skills in the area of cybersecurity by: - Providing CPD on cybersecurity. - Developing additional cyber security resources for teachers, students and parents. - Further develop cyber security links that have been developed between the UCD project team and the Scoilnet portal for hosting primary resources. - Planning for the integration of cyberwise resources into overall cybersecurity supports from 2024.	OIDE TiE/DE	In progress

Measurement and Oversight



Measurement and Oversight Actions

Action.	Measurement And Oversight	DELIVERED BY	Timeline
M.1	Establish Steering Group to oversee and guide implementation of Digital Strategy for Schools to include representation from relevant internal policy areas within the Department who have a role in delivering on actions.	DE	Completed
M.2	Establish Consultative Group to faciliate engagement with relevant stakeholders on the roll out of the Strategy and its associated actions and any relevant developments in this area.	DE	Short term
M.3	Establish Industry Group to provide a formal means of communication between industry and the Department and to faclitate industry supporting digital transformation and capacity building in schools.	DE	Medium term
M.4	Publication of Longitudinal Study on the Digital Learning Framework by the Educational Research Centre and consider recommendations to help inform furture policy and impact of DLF	ERC/DE	Short term
M.5	Consider the evaluation report on the School Excellence Fund Digital & STEM and disseminate relevant findings and learnings to wider system.	DE	Short term
M.6	Commission research on impact of digital technologies in education on learning	DE	Medium term
M.7	Carry out analysis on whether targeted studies or research is needed on particular topics and undertake as appropriate.	DE	Medium term
M.8	Undertake research and examination on AI in education.	DE	Long term
M.9	Undertake preparatory work to faciliate Ireland's participation in the International Computer and Information Literacy Study scheduled for 2028.	DE	Medium term